have helped to stabilize an otherwise volatile region by making the potential costs of large-scale war unacceptably high.

Kapur offers a pessimistic argument regarding the effects of nuclear weapons proliferation in South Asia. Kapur's argument is not based on the organizational factors that dominate leading pessimist analyses of nuclear proliferation. He argues, rather, on rationalist grounds. Kapur's "strategic pessimism" maintains that states' relative military capabilities and territorial preferences can conspire to encourage destabilizing behavior on the part of new nuclear states. Specifically, states that are both weak relative to their principal adversary and dissatisfied with existing territorial arrangements may decide that they can challenge the territorial status quo without facing the danger of catastrophic defeat at the hands of their stronger adversary. And they may believe that ensuing nuclearized crises can attract international attention useful to their cause. Such behavior would occur not because of organizational or other pathologies, but because of states' rational calculation of their politico-military interests. Strategic pessimism thus challenges rational deterrence theory on its own ground showing how nuclear proliferation can increase the likelihood of risky behavior, crisis, and war, even between wholly rational states.

ŠUMIT GANGULY: THE OPTIMISTIC VIEW

A common set of problems afflicts most pessimistic analyses of the South Asian nuclear gyre. They tend to uncritically rely on deductive models and pay inadequate attention to the particular features of the political landscape of South Asia. As a consequence, these analyses, while theoretically sophisticated, have serious empirical shortcomings. For example, the organizational pathologies that Sagan identifies may well have been pertinent to the large, complex, and tightly coupled nuclear forces of the United States and the Soviet Union. But the nuclear forces of India and Pakistan are small, are likely to remain so, and are not tightly coupled. Consequently, the organizational pathologies that afflicted the superpower relationship need not be replicated in South Asia.